GEN 3 SERVICES
GEN 3.1 AERONAUTICAL INFORMATION SERVICES

1 Responsible service

1.1 The Aeronautical Information Service, which forms part of the Department Aviation Infrastructure of the South African Civil Aviation Authority, ensures the flow of information necessary for the safety, regularity and efficiency of international and national air navigation within the area of its responsibility as indicated under para 2 below.

1.2 AIS Headquarters:

South African Civil Aviation Authority Aeronautical Information Services
Ikhaya Lokundiza
Byls Bridge Office Park
Doringkloof
Centurion
0157
Republic of South Africa
TEL: +27 860 267 435
Website: www.caa.co.za

1.3 International NOTAM Office (NOF)

International NOTAM Office
A.T.N.S.
Private Bag X01
Bonaero Park
1622
Republic Of South Africa
Aeronautical Telegraphic Address: FAJNYNYX

Flight Plans
TEL: +2711 928 6518 (international calls)
0860 359 669 (national call share number)

NOTAM
TEL: +2711 928 6592
E-mail: jsnotam@atns.co.za
Website: atns.co.za

2 Area of responsibility

The Aeronautical Information Services (AIS) is responsible for the collection and dissemination of information for the entire area which coincides with the Cape Town, Johannesburg and Johannesburg Oceanic Flight Information Regions (FIRs). The area excludes Lesotho and Eswatini as these states publish their own AIP and NOTAM.

3 Aeronautical publications

3.1 Aeronautical information is published in the form of an Aeronautical Information Product, and consists of the following elements.

- Aeronautical Information Publication (AIP) including amendment service;
- Supplements to the AIP;
- Notice to airmen (NOTAM) and pre-flight information bulletins (PIB);
- Aeronautical Information Circular (AIC).
- Checklists and list of valid NOTAM

AIP, AIP Amendments and AIP supplements shall be made available by most expeditious means.

3.2 Aeronautical Information Publication (AIP)

The publication of an AIP is intended primarily to satisfy international requirements for the exchange of aeronautical information of a lasting character and is essential to Air Navigation.

The AIP constitutes the basic information source for permanent information and long duration temporary changes.
The South African AIP is published in three parts GEN, ENR and AD.

The AIP purchase price is R908-00 (excluding postage), which includes the amendment service for the current year.

Each AIP shall not duplicate information within itself or from other sources.

3.3 AIP Amendment service (AIP AMDT)

Permanent changes to the AIP shall be published as AIP Amendments.

Amendments to AIP shall be issued every 3 months at the following predetermined intervals:-

15 January, 15 April, 15 July, 15 October

When an AIP amendment will not be published at the established interval, a NIL notification shall be originated and distributed by means of the Summary of NOTAM in force (NIF).

Each AIP AMDT shall be allocated a serial number, which shall be consecutive and based on the calendar year. The year, indicated by two digits, is a part of the serial number of the amendment, e.g. AIP AMDT 1/96.

New or revised information contained in the AIP replacement pages will have an annotation (a thick vertical bar) next to the appropriate line. Should a page be reprinted because it was blank or backed a page containing changes, but does not carry any changes in respect to the previous edition, it shall not contain any highlighting symbols (vertical bar).

A checklist of AIP pages containing page number/chart title and the publication or effective date (day, month by name and year) of the information is reissued with each amendment and is an integral part of the AIP.

The AIP amendment service will cost R645-00 per year.

3.4 **AIP Supplement Service (AIP SUP)**

The purpose of the AIP SUP is to bring to the attention of the user any temporary changes of long duration (three months or longer) and/or information of operational significance containing extensive text or graphics, which affect one or more parts of the AIP.

Operationally significant changes shall be published under the AIRAC procedure (refer to paragraph 4).

AIP SUP shall be numbered consecutively based on a calendar year.

The period of validity will normally be given in the AIP SUP itself.

Whenever an AIP SUP is issued to replace a NOTAM, a reference to the serial number of the relevant NOTAM shall be included.

AIP SUP can be cancelled either by an AIP AMDT, AIP SUP or by NOTAM.

A checklist of valid AIP SUP shall be issued at intervals of not more than one month. Such information shall be issued through the monthly summary of NOTAM in force (NIF).

3.5 **AIRAC AIP Supplement (AIRAC AIP SUP)**

The purpose of an AIP SUP is to bring to the attention of the user any temporary changes of long duration (three months or longer) and/or information of operational significance containing extensive text or graphics, which affect one or more parts of the AIP. Operationally significant changes shall be published in accordance with AIRAC procedures and shall be clearly identified by the acronym - AIRAC.

The AIRAC AIP SUP shall be published at least 56 days in advance of the effective date with the objective of reaching recipients at least 28 days in advance of the effective date.

Effective dates will be published in accordance with the predetermined internationally agreed schedule of effective dates based on an interval of 28 days.

Information notified by means of the AIRAC procedure shall not be changed for at least 28 days after the indicated effective date, unless the circumstance notified is of a temporary nature and would not persist for the full period.

When information has not been submitted for publication at the AIRAC date a NIL notification shall be originated and distributed by the monthly printed Plain Language Summary of NIF

3.6 Notice to airmen (NOTAM)

A NOTAM shall be originated and issued concerning the following information:

A NOTAM is a notice distributed by means of the Aeronautical Fixed Service (AFS) containing information concerning the establishment, withdrawal and significant changes in operational capability of radio navigation and air-ground communication services, the timely knowledge of which is essential to personnel concerned with flight operations.

A NOTAM shall be originated and issued promptly whenever the information to be disseminated is of a temporary nature and of short duration or when operationally significant permanent changes, or temporary changes of long duration are made at short notice, except for extensive text or graphics.

NOTAM are originated and issued for South Africa for the entire area which coincides with the Cape Town, Johannesburg and Johannesburg Oceanic Flight Information Regions (FIRs). The area excludes, Lesotho and Eswatini as these States publish NOTAM.

NOTAM are distributed in six series identified by A, B, C, D, E and F:

Each international NOTAM office shall be connected, through the AFS, to the following points within the territory for which it provides service:

a) area control centres and flight information centres;

b) aerodromes/heliports at which an information service is established in accordance with Chapter 8.

Series A: NOTAM containing information of concern to long or medium-range flights, and given selected international distribution.

Series B: NOTAM containing full information on all aerodromes, facilities and procedures available for use in international civil aviation and given international distribution to adjacent States only.

Series C: NOTAM containing information of concern to aircraft other than those engaged in international civil aviation and given national distribution only.

Series D: NOTAM containing information of concern for military airports only and given selected international distribution.

Series E: NOTAM containing information of concern for heliports only and given international distribution to adjacent States only.

Series F: NOTAM containing information of an administrative nature (e.g: Hand amendments, Publications, Trigger NOTAM); and given selected international distribution.

When an AIP AMDT or an AIP SUP is published in accordance with AIRAC procedures, a TRIGGER NOTAM shall be originated giving a brief description of the contents, the effective date, and the reference number to the AIP AMDT or AIP SUP.

The basic purpose of a NOTAM is the dissemination of information in advance of the event to which it relates, except in the case of unserviceability which cannot be foreseen.

A NOTAM checklist shall be issued over the AFS, for each month on the first day of the following month, containing a numerical list of all NOTAM currently in force and referring to the latest AIP AMDT, AIP SUP and AIC issued.

Each NOTAM shall be transmitted as a single telecommunication message.

A NOTAM containing permanent or temporary information of long duration shall carry appropriate AIP or AIP Supplement references.

A monthly Checklist of Aeronautical Information includes a reference of the latest AIP AMDT, checklist of AIP SUP and AIC issued, shall be published on the Civil Aviation Authority website at www.caa.co.za

Pre-flight Information Bulletins (PIB), which contain recapitulation of current NOTAM and other information of urgent character for the operator/flight crews, are available from the Aeronautical Management Services Centre. The extent of the information contained in the PIB is indicated under paragraph 5 of this sub-section.

3.7 **Aeronautical Information Circular (AIC)**

An AIC is a notice containing information that does not qualify for the origination of a NOTAM or for inclusion into the AIP, but which relates to flight safety, air navigation, technical, administrative or legislative matters.

An AIC shall be issued whenever it is necessary to promulgate the following:

- A long-term forecast of any major change in legislation, regulations, procedures or facilities.
- Information of a purely explanatory or advisory nature liable to affect flight safety.
- Information or notification of an explanatory or advisory nature concerning technical, legislative or administrative matters.

AIC's are classified into the following subjects - General, Operation of Aircraft, Personnel Licensing, Air Navigation Services, Aerodromes and Airworthiness.

Serial numbers will be allocated which shall be consecutive and based on the calendar year. E.g. 001/2014, 002/2014 etc.

Series Subject
A - General
B - Operation of Aircraft
C - Personnel Licensing
D - Air Navigation Services
E - Aerodromes
F - Airworthiness

Further sub-divisions shall also be used e.g.

Series B - Operation of Aircraft	General
Series B - Operation of Aircraft	Safety
Series B - Operation of Aircraft	Regulation
Series B - Operation of Aircraft	Accidents and Incidents etc

The date of issue will appear on each AIC.

A check list of AIC (AIC 10.2) currently in force shall be available from the CAA website at www.caa.co.za under Aeronautical Information.

4 AIRAC System

4.1 In order to control and regulate the operationally significant changes requiring amendments to charts, route manuals e.t.c., such changes, whenever possible, will be issued on predetermined dates according to the AIRAC SYSTEM. This type of information will be published as an AIRAC AIP SUP.

4.2 The table below indicates AIRAC effective dates for the coming years. AIRAC information will be issued so that the information will be received by the user not later than 28 days, and for major changes not later than 56 days, before the effective date. At AIRAC effective date, a trigger NOTAM will be issued giving a brief description of the contents, effective date and reference number of the AIP AMDT or AIRAC AIP SUP that will become effective on that date. Trigger NOTAM will remain in force as a reminder in the PIB until the new checklist/summary is issued.

If no information was submitted for publication at the AIRAC date, a NIL notification will be issued by NOTAM not later than one AIRAC cycle before the AIRAC effective date concerned.

4.3 Schedule of AIRAC effective dates

2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
22 January	21 January	20 January	18 January	17 January
19 February	18 February	17 February	15 February	14 February
19 March	18 March	16 March	15 March	14 March
16 April	15 April	13 April	12 April	11 April
14 May	13 May	11 May	10 May	09 May
11 June	10 June	08 June	07 June	06 June
09 July	08 July	06 July	05 July	04 July
06 August	05 August	03 August	02 August	01 August
03 September	02 September	31 August	30 August	29 August
01 October	30 September	28 September	27 September	26 September
29 October	28 October	26 October	25 October	24 October
26 November	25 November	23 November	22 November	21 November
24 December	23 December	21 December	20 December	19 December

5 Pre-Flight Information

For any aerodrome/heliport used for international air operations, aeronautical information relative to the route stages originating at the aerodrome/heliport shall be made available to flight operations personnel, including flight crews and services responsible for pre-flight information.

Additional current information relating to the aerodrome of departure shall be provided concerning the following:
Failure, irregular operation and changes in the operational status of radio navigation services, VHF aeromobile channels, RVR observing system and secondary power supply.

NOTAM are important because they communicate important flight and safety information to pilots and other personnel who may need them. Because they're delivered in a timely manner, it's important for pilots to be aware of the different NOTAM and to react to the notices immediately. Conducting effective briefings is an essential part of flight preparation. Without proper preparation, a crew will not have the necessary situational awareness to fly at maximum effectiveness and safety.

It is therefore the responsibility of the pilot/flight crews to obtain the latest NOTAM information and conduct a thorough briefing on the latest NOTAM prior to their flight thus ensuring that all crew members operating the aircraft and responsible for the safe conduct of a flight are aware of the most important parameters.

6 Pre-Flight Information Service at aerodromes/heliports.

Pre-flight information service is available through one of the following means:

The AIM Service Centre

Hours of service: MON-SUN 24HR

Contact details: +2711 928 6518 (international calls)
0860 359 669 (national call share number)

File2Fly Internet self-briefing service

Hours of Service: MON-SUN 24HR

Contact details: https://file2fly.atns.co.za

AIRPORT	COVERAGE
O R Tambo International Airport.	Republic of South Africa, Botswana, Lesotho, Eswatini, Mozambique, Mauritius, Zambia, Malawi, Namibia, Algeria, Ghana, Tunisia, Belgium, Germany, Finland, United Kingdom, Netherlands, Sweden, Congo, Madagascar, Cameroon, Gabon, Central African Republic, Equatorial Guinea, Angola, Seychelles, Zimbabwe, Democratic Republic of Congo, Morocco, Senegal, Burkina Faso, Cote D'ivoire, Niger, Mali, Guinea-Bissau, Mauritania, Cape Verde, Ethiopia, Burundi, Somalia, Egypt, Eritrea, Kenya, Libya, Sudan, United Republic of Tanzania, Uganda, United States, Spain, Canary Islands, Gibraltar, France, Greece, Italy, Albania, Israel, Malta, Austria, Switzerland, Republic of Moldova, Yugoslav Republic of Macedonia, Honduras, Gautemala, Nicaragua, Costa Rica, El Salvador, Afghanis tan, Bahrain, Saudi Arabia, Iran, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, United Arab Emirates, Oman, Pakistan, Iraq, Syrian Arab Republic, China, Japan, Argentina, Brazil, Sri Lanka, India, Hong Kong, Maldives, Malaysia, Singapore, Australia, Macao, Vietnam, Portugal, Denmark, Nigeria, Poland, Russia.

Daily NOTAM Summaries and Pre-flight Information Bulletins (PIB) are available from the AIM Service Centre.

A pre-flight information bulletin and NOTAM Summaries can be distributed by e-mail, or AFTN.

Post Flight Information Form, see (AIC 004/2018), for post-flight annotation by flight crews of information concerning the state, operation and reliability of air navigation facilities, are available on the ATNS website, www.atns.co.za, under the Post Flight Report on the AIM sub-menu.